Since its inception, Israel had adopted a strategy of containment toward Iraq, consisting of the following elements:

- Strategic cooperation with Iran, which had both an intelligence aspect and an operational aspect vis-à-vis Iraq, and which, of course, was halted following the Khomeini revolution of 1979
- Strategic cooperation with Turkey, which had experienced ups and downs over the years, but which in general had allowed Israel to get a "look and feel" for Iraq from the Turkish side of the border
- Strategic intelligence cooperation with the Kurds in northern Iraq, including the continuous presence of forces in the territory, with Iran serving as a territorial rear for this cooperation

Iraq had always been a concern of the Israeli intelligence community, but its place on the list of priorities of the EEI began to change in the early 1970s and onwards.

In 1970, Egyptian president Gamal Abdel Nasser died, and Anwar Sadat was appointed in his place. From the day he came to power in Egypt, Sadat concocted the idea of the Yom Kippur War, which he carried out in October 1973. In the wake of the war, the seeds of peace with Egypt were sown, and they grew into a peace treaty in 1979. After the war, Syria occupied the number one place on the Israeli EEI, though throughout the forty years that have passed since the Yom Kippur War, not a single bullet has been fired from Syrian territory into Israel. Jordan, during this period, was not considered a threat to Israel (unless the regime were to change). In Saddam Hussein's Iraq, on the other hand, there was the growing threat of strategic weapons that included military chemical, biological, and nuclear capabilities as well as surface-to-surface missiles. The Israeli air force attacked the nuclear reactor near Baghdad on June 7, 1981, rendering it useless. Exactly one year later, on June 6, 1982, the First Lebanon War began, which plunged the IDF into becoming a presence in Lebanon for many years; at the same time, Iraq went to war against Iran for eight years, all while continuing its efforts to develop its strategic capabilities.

From the end of the 1973 Yom Kippur War until the outbreak of the "Arab Spring" at the beginning of 2011, Syria was the number one priority on Israel's EEI. This fact had far-reaching implications for the directing of